

This command starts a Python terminal session. You should see a Python prompt (`>>>`), which means macOS has found the version of Python you just installed.

Enter the following line in the terminal session:

```
>>> print("Hello Python interpreter!")
Hello Python interpreter!
>>>
```

You should see the message `Hello Python interpreter!`, which should print directly in the current terminal window. You can close the Python interpreter by pressing `CTRL-D` or by entering the command `exit()`.

NOTE

On newer macOS systems, you'll see a percent sign (%) as a terminal prompt instead of a dollar sign (\$).

Installing VS Code

To install the VS Code editor, you need to download the installer at <https://code.visualstudio.com>. Click the **Download** button, and then open a **Finder** window and go to the **Downloads** folder. Drag the **Visual Studio Code** installer to your Applications folder, then double-click the installer to run it.

Skip over the following section about Python on Linux, and follow the steps in “Running a Hello World Program” on page 9.

Python on Linux

Linux systems are designed for programming, so Python is already installed on most Linux computers. The people who write and maintain Linux expect you to do your own programming at some point, and encourage you to do so. For this reason, there's very little to install and only a few settings to change to start programming.

Checking Your Version of Python

Open a terminal window by running the Terminal application on your system (in Ubuntu, you can press `CTRL-ALT-T`). To find out which version of Python is installed, enter `python3` with a lowercase *p*. When Python is installed, this command starts the Python interpreter. You should see output indicating which version of Python is installed. You should also see a Python prompt (`>>>`) where you can start entering Python commands:

```
$ python3
Python 3.10.4 (main, Apr . . . , 09:04:19) [GCC 11.2.0] on linux
Type "help", "copyright", "credits" or "license" for more information.
>>>
```

This output indicates that Python 3.10.4 is currently the default version of Python installed on this computer. When you've seen this output, press `CTRL-D` or enter `exit()` to leave the Python prompt and return to a